RC Catamaran: What to Buy

Mini Cat, 1 m boat and foiling kit

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Prices read on retailer pages 23–25 September 2026

The plan

Build in three stages, each after the one before sails well. The build manuals (`mini/manual/` and `manual_1m/`) say what each part is for and how it goes together.

	List price	To buy, in this order
Stage 1: Mini Cat 600	$257.37	$257.37
Stage 2: 1 m boat (daggerboards)	$384.49	$294.76[†]
Stage 3: foiling kit	$101.17	$101.17
All three		**$653.30**

[†] The radio, its AA cells and the NiMH pack bought for the Mini ($89.73) move to the 1 m boat. Leftover filament, epoxy, glue, sail cloth and line from one stage may cover part of the next; the lists assume new stock.

Prices exclude shipping and tax. They were read on the retailers' pages on the dates above (the Mini's links were re-checked on 24 September). Check them before ordering. Under each item, in italics, is the listing the price came from, with the part number where there is one and a note where the price is uncertain.

Also needed, not priced above

- **A 3D printer** that prints PETG, with a bed of at least 220 x 220 mm. Every part is sized for that bed; two print diagonally (the 1 m manual says which).
- **A NiMH charger** for the eneloop AA cells. One checked option: the Panasonic charger bundled with 4 more eneloop AA cells, $32.09 at Walmart on 24 September 2026 [24].
- **Hand tools**, assumed on hand: hobby knife and steel rule; drill bits 1.2, 1.5, 2, 2.5 and 3.2 mm (a pin vise is enough); side cutters and round-nose pliers for the music wire; 240-grit sandpaper; masking tape; a fine-tip soldering iron or hot needle for holes in the sailcloth; small screwdrivers; a 0.9 mm hex key for the elevator trim screws; a bucket or sink for leak tests; a kitchen scale.
- Servo screws come with the servos.

Order by store

Orders grouped by store, with the carried-over radio and battery counted once.

Store	Items	Subtotal	Stages
HobbyTown	10	$149.19	1, 2, 3
CST (cstsales.com)	11	$137.65	1, 2, 3
Elegoo US	3	$55.96	1, 2, 3
kiteboarding.com	2	$44.85	1, 2
Jones Airfoils	2	$43.98	1, 2
AliExpress	3	$33.39	1, 2
Wind Catcher RC	1	$32.56	2
Pololu	1	$32.06	2
K&S Metals	6	$29.93	1, 2, 3
Walmart	2	$28.86	1, 2
RMRC	1	$24.52	2
Easy Composites	1	$20.70	3
MicroBattery	1	$12.75	1
Waveshare	2	$5.18	1, 2
Bolt Depot	1	$1.72	3

Parts by stage

Stage 1: Mini Cat 600 (build first) **$257.37**

Item	Used for	Qty	Unit	Total	Store [link]
FlySky FS-i6X + FS-iA6B receiver	CH1 rudder, CH3 sails (non-centering stick); reused on the 1 m boat	1	$69.99	$69.99	HobbyTown [1]
AA alkaline x4 *HobbyTown (EcoPower AA x4 add-on)*	transmitter power	1	$2.99	$2.99	HobbyTown [2]
JX W4505-2T sail winch servo *AliExpress: listed $5.79 at 48% off; full price used*	both sheets on the stepped drum	1	$11.13	$11.13	AliExpress [3]
MG90S metal-gear micro servo	rudders via pushrod + tie bar	1	$2.59	$2.59	Waveshare [4]
Panasonic eneloop AA 2000 mAh, 4-pack	receiver pack (4.8 V)	1	$12.75	$12.75	MicroBattery [5]
Traxxas 4-cell AA holder with switch (TRA1523)	receiver battery box + on/off	1	$4.00	$4.00	HobbyTown [6]
PETG filament 1 kg	hulls, box, lid, rudders, boards, drum (about 470 g used)	1	$13.99	$13.99	Elegoo US [7]
Carbon tube 10 x 8 mm x 1 m *CST CS-525 1M*	two 360 mm crossbeams	1	$16.15	$16.15	CST (cstsales.com) [8]
Carbon tube 6 x 4 mm x 1 m *CST CS-518 1M*	mast (800 mm)	1	$15.25	$15.25	CST (cstsales.com) [8]

Item	Used for	Qty	Unit	Total	Store [link]
Carbon tube 4 mm OD x 1 m *CST CS-508 1M*	boom (210 mm)	1	$8.49	$8.49	CST (cstsales.com) [8]
Carbon rod 1.2 mm x 1 m *CST CS-316 1M*	3 battens	1	$3.47	$3.47	CST (cstsales.com) [9]
Music wire 0.125 in *K&S 0.125 in x 12 in*	rudder stocks	1	$3.99	$3.99	K&S Metals [10]
Music wire 0.093 in *K&S 0.093 in x 12 in*	tie bar, tiller arms	1	$3.99	$3.99	K&S Metals [10]
Music wire 0.047 in *K&S 0.047 in x 12 in (3 pcs)*	rudder pushrod, sheet hooks	1	$3.99	$3.99	K&S Metals [10]
Du-Bro micro pushrod system	clevis + tube for the rudder pushrod	1	$8.55	$8.55	HobbyTown [11]
Icarex PC31 ripstop polyester, 1 m *Jones Airfoils, per metre (138 cm wide)*	main + jib (0.145 m2)	1	$21.99	$21.99	Jones Airfoils [12]
Ripstop sail tape 2 in, 10 ft *kiteboarding.com: $15.00 base + $5.85 for 10 ft*	luff, batten pockets, corners	1	$20.85	$20.85	kiteboarding.com [13]
Braided PE line 30 lb *Walmart, PowerPro 30 lb x 150 yd (read 2026-09-24; the original eBay listing had ended)*	stays, bridle, sheets	1	$14.43	$14.43	Walmart [14]
BSI 5-minute epoxy 4.5 oz	hull segment joints, beams, fittings	1	$13.99	$13.99	HobbyTown [15]
BSI gap-filling CA 1/2 oz	small parts, knots	1	$4.79	$4.79	HobbyTown [16]
Total				**$257.37**	

Stage 2: 1 m boat with daggerboards **$384.49**

Item	Used for	Qty	Unit	Total	Store [link]
FlySky FS-i6X + FS-iA6B receiver†	4 channels used: rudder, traveler, jib, mainsheet	1	$69.99	$69.99	HobbyTown [1]
AA alkaline x4† *HobbyTown (EcoPower AA x4 add-on)*	transmitter power	1	$2.99	$2.99	HobbyTown [2]
JX W4505-4T sail winch servo *AliExpress: listed $5.79 at 48% off; full price used*	traveler (about 209 mm of car travel, rig model)	1	$11.13	$11.13	AliExpress [3]
JX W4505-2T sail winch servo *AliExpress: listed $5.79 at 48% off; full price used*	jib sheet (about 82 mm of sheet, rig model)	1	$11.13	$11.13	AliExpress [3]
Feetech FS5115M standard servo	mainsheet tension	1	$32.06	$32.06	Pololu [17]
MG90S metal-gear micro servo	rudders via pushrod + tie bar	1	$2.59	$2.59	Waveshare [4]
Panasonic eneloop AA 2000 mAh, 4-pack†	receiver pack (4.8 V)	1	$12.75	$12.75	MicroBattery [5]

Item	Used for	Qty	Unit	Total	Store [link]
Traxxas 4-cell AA holder with switch (TRA1523)†	receiver battery box + on/off	1	$4.00	$4.00	HobbyTown [6]
PETG filament 1 kg	hulls, pod, lid, rudder-servo bracket and cover, rudders, boards, gudgeons, tracks, cars, mast fairing and fittings (about 1.5 kg used, 1 m manual print list)	2	$13.99	$27.98	Elegoo US [7]
Carbon tube 16 x 14 mm x 1 m *Wind Catcher RC (price from search listing, page not reachable from here)*	two 600 mm crossbeams	2	$16.28	$32.56	Wind Catcher RC [18]
Carbon tube 12 x 10 mm x 1 m	two-piece mast (1.3 m)	2	$12.26	$24.52	RMRC [19]
Carbon tube 10 x 8 mm x 1 m *CST CS-525 1M*	mast joiner spigot (150 mm) and pod beam (600 mm)	1	$16.15	$16.15	CST (cstsales.com) [8]
Carbon tube 8 x 7 mm x 1 m *CST CS-529 1M*	boom (345 mm)	1	$17.20	$17.20	CST (cstsales.com) [8]
Carbon rod 1.2 mm x 2 m *CST CS-316 2M*	8 battens (2.01 m in all; finish them from the 1 m rod)	1	$5.25	$5.25	CST (cstsales.com) [9]
Carbon rod 1.2 mm x 1 m *CST CS-316 1M*	the last batten, daggerboard joint rods (4 x 80 mm)	1	$3.47	$3.47	CST (cstsales.com) [9]
Music wire 0.156 in *K&S 0.156 in x 12 in*	rudder stocks, tie bar	2	$4.99	$9.98	K&S Metals [10]
Music wire 0.093 in *K&S 0.093 in x 12 in*	rudder pushrod, track end-stop turning pins, gooseneck pin, boom sheet eye	1	$3.99	$3.99	K&S Metals [10]
Du-Bro micro pushrod system	clevises	1	$8.55	$8.55	HobbyTown [11]
Icarex PC31 ripstop polyester, 1 m *Jones Airfoils, per metre (138 cm wide)*	main + jib (0.40 m2)	1	$21.99	$21.99	Jones Airfoils [12]
Ripstop sail tape 2 in, half roll *kiteboarding.com: $15.00 base + $9.00 half roll*	luff, batten pockets, corners	1	$24.00	$24.00	kiteboarding.com [13]
Braided PE line 30 lb *Walmart, PowerPro 30 lb x 150 yd (read 2026-09-24; the original eBay listing had ended)*	stays, bridle, sheets	1	$14.43	$14.43	Walmart [14]
BSI 5-minute epoxy 9 oz	hull joints, beams, fittings	1	$22.99	$22.99	HobbyTown [20]
BSI gap-filling CA 1/2 oz	small parts	1	$4.79	$4.79	HobbyTown [16]
Total				**$384.49**	

† Already bought for the Mini Cat: the radio, its AA cells and the NiMH pack move to the 1 m boat, so if you build the Mini first, Stage 2 costs $294.76 instead of $384.49.

Stage 3: foiling kit (v2.3 foils) **$101.17**

Item	Used for	Qty	Unit	Total	Store [link]
PETG filament 1 kg	L-foil, elevator and flap cores, trim pods, ride-height linkage (about 290 g, 1 m manual print list)	1	$13.99	$13.99	Elegoo US [7]
Unidirectional carbon tape 2 in x 12 ft *CST CU-379: 2 in unidirectional carbon, 0.005 in, 12 ft*	spar caps: 4 layers per face on struts, wings, elevators	2	$19.95	$39.90	CST (cstsales.com) [21]
EL2 laminating epoxy 500 g *Easy Composites EL2, 500 g kit*	wet-out of the caps	1	$20.70	$20.70	Easy Composites [22]
Carbon rod 1.2 mm x 1 m *CST CS-316 1M*	flap hinge pins	1	$3.47	$3.47	CST (cstsales.com) [9]
Carbon rod 2 mm x 1 m *CST CS-323 1M (2 mm)*	two 300 mm ride-height wands, elevator pivot pins, wand and bellcrank axles, L-foil core dowels	1	$8.85	$8.85	CST (cstsales.com) [9]
Music wire 0.047 in *K&S 0.047 in x 12 in (3 pcs)*	wand-to-flap pushrods	1	$3.99	$3.99	K&S Metals [10]
Du-Bro micro pushrod system	clevises for the flap linkage	1	$8.55	$8.55	HobbyTown [11]
M2 x 6 mm stainless set screw, cup point (Bolt Depot 8697) *Bolt Depot, per piece (read 2026-09-25)*	elevator trim screws, two per trim pod	4	$0.43	$1.72	Bolt Depot [23]
Total				**$101.17**	

Options for the Mini (not in its total)

Item	Used for	Qty	Unit	Total	Store [link]
EcoPower 640T waterproof micro servo	instead of MG90S	1	$29.99	$29.99	HobbyTown [25]
FlySky FS-GT2E + FS-A3 (car radio) *HobbyTown (re-read 2026-09-24; now sold with the FS-A3 receiver)*	instead of FS-i6X; throttle trigger springs back to centre	1	$38.99	$38.99	HobbyTown [2]

Links

[1] https://www.hobbytown.com/flysky-i6x-6channel-afhds-2a-air-radio-system-w-ia6b-receiver-fsy-i6xia6b/p1674181

[2] https://www.hobbytown.com/flysky-fsgt2e-2channel-transmitter-w-fsa3-receiver-fsy-fs-gt2ea3/p1592822

[3] https://www.aliexpress.com/item/1005003265131874.html

[4] https://www.waveshare.com/mg90s-servo.htm

[5] https://www.microbattery.com/panasonic-bk-3mcca4ba-eneloop-aa-2100-cycle-ni-mh-pre-charged-rechargeable-batteries-4-pack80.html

[6] https://www.hobbytown.com/traxxas-4cell-aa-battery-holder-w-switch-cover-tra1523/p49945

[7] https://us.elegoo.com/products/rapid-petg-filament-1-75mm-colored-1kg

[8] https://www.cstsales.com/Carbon_Fiber_Tubes.html

[9] https://www.cstsales.com/carbon_rods.html

[10] https://ksmetals.com/collections/12-long-music-wire

[11] https://www.hobbytown.com/dubro-pushrod-system-micro-dub847/p29360

[12] https://jonesairfoils.com/products/icarex

[13] https://kiteboarding.com/proddetail.asp?prod=ripstop_2inch

[14] https://www.walmart.com/ip/PowerPro-Braided-Fishing-Line-30lb-x-150yd-ylw-21100300150Y/17117880

[15] https://www.hobbytown.com/bob-smith-industries-quickcure-5-minute-epoxy-4-1-2oz-bsi201/p37081

[16] https://www.hobbytown.com/bob-smith-industries-instacure-gap-filling-ca-1-2oz-bsi106/p37055

[17] https://www.pololu.com/product/3426

[18] https://windcatcherrc.com/product/carbon-fiber-tube-16mm-x-14mm-x-1000mm/

[19] https://www.readymaderc.com/products/details/carbon-fiber-tube-12mm-x-10mm-1m-long

[20] https://www.hobbytown.com/bob-smith-industries-quickcure-5-minute-epoxy-9o-bsi202/p37082

[21] https://www.cstsales.com/heat_tack.html

[22] https://www.easycomposites.us/el2-epoxy-laminating-resin

[23] https://boltdepot.com/Product-Details?product=8697

[24] https://www.walmart.com/ip/Panasonic-Battery-Charger-with-4-eneloop-AA-Rechargeable-Batteries-4-Count/124706107

[25] https://www.hobbytown.com/ecopower-640t-13g-waterproof-metal-gear-digital-sub-micro-servo-ecp-640t/p859667